

Nicholas D. Gray, Ph.D.

DATA SCIENTIST

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Data scientist with nearly four years of industry experience in insurance analytics, built on a decade of quantitative research training. Combines a Ph.D. in Cognitive Psychology with hands-on expertise in SQL, Python, and machine learning to turn large, messy data sources into models, reports, and recommendations that stakeholders act on.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Tools	Python (advanced), SQL / Microsoft SQL Server, R, MATLAB, Microsoft Excel (advanced)
Machine Learning	XGBoost & gradient boosting, Regression (linear & logistic), Predictive modeling, Model evaluation
Data & Analysis	ETL & data cleaning, Exploratory data analysis, Statistical inference, Experimental design, Survey & qualitative analysis
Communication	Stakeholder reporting, Data visualization, Technical writing, Teaching & presentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Data Science Associate

Oct 2022 – Present

Safety National Casualty Corporation · St. Louis, MO

- Build analytics reports and dashboards used by internal teams and external stakeholders across the business.
- Extract and join data from large, complex sources in Microsoft SQL Server, then transform and clean it in Python for analysis.
- Develop machine-learning models — including XGBoost — that produce business-relevant predictions for underwriting and claims questions.
- Design custom analyses out of exploratory investigation, tailoring method and reporting to the decision each stakeholder actually faces.

Postdoctoral Researcher — Quantitative Analysis

Aug 2019 – Oct 2022

Institute for Successful Longevity, Florida State University · Tallahassee, FL

- Led statistical analysis for large-scale behavioral clinical trials on healthy cognitive aging, working across longitudinal datasets and multiple analysis platforms.
- Established statistical performance norms and built regression models identifying the variables that drive cognitive outcomes.
- Integrated qualitative streams — surveys and interviews — with quantitative measures to produce findings neither would support alone.
- Designed and programmed novel studies end to end and published the results in peer-reviewed journals.

Graduate Researcher

Aug 2013 – May 2019

Department of Psychology, Florida State University · Tallahassee, FL

- Modeled experimental data with logistic regression and related statistical methods across several software platforms.
- Designed, programmed, and ran grant-funded experimental research; managed the lab, recruiting and supervising undergraduate researchers.
- Taught laboratory sections of Cognitive Psychology and co-instructed Careers in Psychology (2014–2019), translating complex statistical concepts for non-expert audiences.

SELECTED PROJECTS

adherence – Python · github.com/ndg13b/adherence

A statistics package that scores how regular someone's engagement is — not just how much of it there is — and turns that into a forecast of when they will next show up.

CivicGateway – JavaScript · civicgateway.org

A nonpartisan site showing upcoming elections and elected officials by city; static front end over a Supabase/PostgreSQL schema with row-level security and an offline fallback.

tuned-in – JavaScript · ndg13b.github.io/tuned-in

A teaching collection pairing pop-culture clips with the cognitive psychology they demonstrate — and, just as often, get wrong.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Cognitive Psychology

2019

Florida State University

Thesis: The causes of and influences on being reminded

M.S., Cognitive Psychology

2016

Florida State University

Thesis: Avoiding interference: Differentiation and reminding

B.S., Psychology, cum laude

2012

Ohio State University

Additional coursework: Machine Learning with Python; Microsoft SQL Server (independently completed)

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Gray, N., & Charness, N. (2022). Technology obsolescence across the adult lifespan in a USA internet sample. *Frontiers in Public Health*, 10, 1005822.

Gray, N., Yoon, J.-S., Charness, N., Boot, W. R., et al. (2021). Relative effectiveness of general versus specific cognitive training for aging adults. *Psychology and Aging*, 37(2), 210–221.

Carr, D. C., Tian, S., He, Z., et al., incl. Gray, N. (2022). Motivation to engage in aging research: Are there typologies and predictors? *The Gerontologist*, gnac035.

Charness, N., Boot, W. R., & Gray, N. (2020). Mobile monitoring and intervention technology (MMI) for adaptive aging. In *Mobile Technology for Adaptive Aging: Proceedings of a Workshop* (pp. 21–40). National Academies Press.

Conference presentations at the Psychonomic Society (2018) and the Cognitive Aging Conference (2022).